

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4
 ♥ 9 6 5
 ♦ K 9 6 2
 ♣ Q J 10 9

♠ A J 10 8 5 2

♥ K J 4

♦ A 8

♣ K 6



♠ K 6

♥ 8 7 3

♦ Q J 10 4

♣ A 8 3 2

♠ Q 9 3

♥ A Q 10 2

♦ 7 5 3

♣ 7 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by North

letting it ride. East wins with his ♠K, but cannot play ♣s from his side of the table without handing you a trick. Whatever else he plays you win, pull trumps, and discard a ♣ loser on dummy's fourth ♥.

At notrump you usually hold up to exhaust one player of a suit so he cannot lead that suit back to his partner.

At suit contracts the most common reason for a hold-up is to keep the Danger Hand from getting the lead.

North is to play 4 ♠. East leads the ♦Q. West plays the ♦9.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 4

On the plus side dummy has an extra ♥ winner on which you could discard a loser from your hand. The danger is that when you take the trump finesse, East might win the ♠K and put his partner in the lead with the ♦K for a ♣ play through your ♣K.

To prevent that from happening all you have to do is hold up on the first ♦. You have to lose one trick in the suit no matter what, so lose it right now to East, the Safe Hand. East continues with another ♦ which you win.

You go over to dummy with a ♥ and play the ♠Q, letting it ride. East wins with his ♠K, but cannot play ♣s from his side of the table without handing you a trick. Whatever else he plays you win, pull trumps, and discard a ♣ loser on dummy's fourth ♥.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 6 3
 ♥ K Q 10 8 5
 ♦ K 10 9
 ♣ 7 2

♠ K Q 9

♥ A 3 2

♦ 7 5 3

♣ Q 9 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 5 2

♥ 9 6

♦ A J 6 2

♣ 10 8 3

♠ A 8 4

♥ J 7 4

♦ Q 8 4

♣ A K J 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

1NT

3NT by South

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥K.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=4 Total = 8

Unless there is a miracle in the ♦s, (or a defensive error), you can't get a trick in that suit. But you have a chance for a second ♥ trick.

It's the Bath Coup again, just dressed up a little differently.

Let West hold the first trick, playing the ♥7 from your hand to conceal the ♥4 in the hope that West will continue the suit. If he does you have your ninth trick - if he doesn't, good luck.

Compare this Bath Coup to the one in Deal 10.